

Portable Media Players

Entry Level PMPs Cowon iAudio 7

The Cowon iAudio 7 is a lot of player per cubic inch. Not only is it novel looking, but the novel touch-based controls also work well and the screen, while not good enough for video playback is pretty legible. Sound quality is absolutely amazing for a player of this price range. Obviously, it's not as refined as the Apple iPod Classic and iPod Touch, but neither does it command as hefty a price tag. At Rs. 4,999 for the 4 GB version, and with the 2 GB version costing a good thousand rupees less, this is our unanimous choice for a Zero1 Award.



Discrete PMPs still get preference over cell-phones when it comes to discerning users, to whom quality matters.

Mid-range PMP Apple iPod Nano Video 8 GB

It's a golden day for Apple indeed, when a newer player from their stables is the only one can dethrone the reigning champion. In terms of sound quality, in terms of portability, the look and feel of the product, the iPod Nano Video comes up with all aces. There's hardly anything not to like about this product and now available with the added bit of FM Radio and a video recorder, which by the way isn't that great at all. Yet the feature is available at no extra cost. For Rs. 9,400, you get a lot of PMP for the money.



Best Performer Apple iPod Classic

The Classic is truly *classic*. A product line that Apple has stubbornly continued despite rivals shifting over to flash-based players, the Classic represents the best of both worlds — storage and performance. With up to a 160 GB of space, it's enough to cart around some 3000-odd lossless audio files or your entire collection of MP3s. The 2.5-inch display is also good enough for movies with great colour, crispness and clarity. However the Classic is a little bulky, but then that's understandable and not really a trade-off for the audiophile. If you're looking for something with absolute sonic authority, the Classic is one of the best, most neutral sounding PMPs we've ever come across. It's wins our Zero 1 Award for its sterling performance.



Premium PMP Apple iPod Touch 3rd Generation

The iPod Touch is a venerable addition to Apple's lineup and can be considered as a serious all-in-one device. The interface, the additional goodies in terms of applications and games, the large screen that rocks for movies and the superb audio quality all add up to one thing — a class device that will suit anyone who is willing to shell out and who doesn't want something compact, which it's not. It's an ultra capable device and one that literally has something for everyone. The latest generation also features up to 64 GB of storage, though the cheaper 16 and 32 GB variants are also available — truly Zero 1 Award material.

